

The Constitution of the Dalhousie Mathematics and Statistics Graduate Students' Society

2026

Purpose

The Dalhousie Mathematics and Statistics Graduate Students' Society (MSGSS, hereafter known as "the Society") is the graduate students' society of the Mathematics and Statistics department at Dalhousie University. The society aims to promote the interests of its members and to act as a social institution for the benefit of its members. The Society is a service provider that exists to serve its membership both individually and collectively, upholding all members' fundamental right to live, learn, and work in a safe and comfortable environment.

Article I: Membership and Privileges

1. Full members of the society shall be any graduate student who is registered as part- or full-time student in the department of Mathematics and Statistics at Dalhousie University.
2. Associate membership is available for any person interested in the activities of the society after obtaining approval of the society's executive. Post-doctoral members in the Mathematics and Statistics Department are automatically granted associate membership.
3. There shall be no membership fee or dues as a requirement of membership in the Society.
4. Membership is not limited based on characteristics which are classified as protected grounds under the Canadian Human Rights Act. This includes, but is not limited to, age, race disability status, gender identity, marital status, sexual orientation, and religion.

Article 2: Board of Directors (Council)

1. Composition of the Board of Directors (Council) shall be the following: President, Vice President External, Vice President Internal, Mathematics Masters Director, Mathematics Doctoral Director, Statistics Masters Director, and the Statistics Doctoral Director.
2. Any full member of the Society shall be eligible to seek election to and hold office on the Board of Directors providing the eligibility requirements as outlined in The Bylaws of the Dalhousie Mathematics and Statistics Graduate Students Society Bylaws (Bylaws) are met.
3. Each member of the Board of Directors shall be responsible for upholding their respective duties as outlined in the Bylaws.

Article 3: Constitutional Amendments

1. Amendments to the Constitution of the Society may be initiated through a motion by a General Meeting.
2. Notice of a motion to amend the Constitution shall be presented in writing to the Vice President Internal at least one week prior to the meeting at which it is to be proposed.
3. The proposed amendments shall be clearly posted at least one week prior to the meeting at which it is to be voted upon.
4. Constitutional amendments shall be passed upon obtaining more than 50% of the votes cast.

Article 4: Bylaws

1. The operation and governance of the Board of Directors shall follow the Bylaws of the society.
2. No Bylaw shall contradict the provisions of the Constitution. Bylaws shall serve to clarify, elaborate, or complement the provisions of the Constitution.
3. Bylaws may be initiated or amended through a motion by a General Meeting.
4. Notice of a motion to amend the bylaws shall be presented in writing to the Vice President Internal at least one week prior to the meeting at which it is to be proposed.
5. The proposed amendments shall be clearly posted at least one week prior to the meeting at which they are to be voted upon.
6. Bylaws shall be effective immediately (unless otherwise stated in the proposed Bylaw) unless the Bylaw contradicts the Constitution.
7. The procedure to amend a Bylaw after it has been duly constituted as a Bylaw shall require the same process as the passage of a Bylaw. The procedure to rescind the Bylaw shall be the same as the passage of a Bylaw, with over 50% of the General Meeting voting in favour of rescinding the Bylaw.
8. If two bylaws are found to be in contradiction with one another, or if a bylaw is found to contradict itself, then the Council must meet to: (a) propose and vote on a resolution; (b) schedule a General Meeting to amend the conflicting bylaws. The resolution passed by the Council will stay in effect for up to one (1) month and will end as soon as the bylaws have been amended.

Article 5: General Meetings

1. The Board of Directors shall hold a minimum of one (1) Annual General Meeting of the members of the Society. This meeting will be held near the beginning of each Fall Term to coincide with the welcoming of new graduate students into the society. All members are informed of activities planned and of ways they can

become involved. Elections for the executive are also held at this time.

2. Quorum for a General Meeting shall be no less than ten (10) members of the Society, three (3) of which must be members of Council.
3. and any additional General Meetings may be called at the discretion of the Board of Directors or by a petition delivered to the Board of Directors signed by three (3) members of the Society.